

Chapter 2

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Worksheet for Chapter 2: Exploring Cultural Identity

Objective: To help students reflect on and apply the concepts of cultural identity, intersectionality, cultural pride and challenges, and sharing stories through personal exploration and critical thinking.

Part 1: Reflecting on Components of Cultural Identity

Instructions: Think about the components of cultural identity discussed in the chapter (family, language, religion, and traditions). Answer the following questions to explore how these elements shape who you are. Write 2-3 sentences for each.

- **Family:** How does your family influence your cultural identity? Describe a specific habit, value, or practice in your household that connects to your culture.
- **Language:** What role does language play in your identity? Do you speak a language or use specific words/phrases that tie you to your heritage?
- **Religion:** How does religion or spiritual practice (or lack thereof) impact your cultural identity? Mention a related holiday, ritual, or belief if applicable.
- **Traditions:** What is one tradition (big or small) that makes you feel connected to your culture? Describe it briefly.

Part 2: Exploring Intersectionality

Instructions: Intersectionality is about how different parts of your identity overlap to shape your experiences. Draw a small "Identity Web" below by writing "Me" in the center and connecting 3-4 aspects of your identity (e.g., gender, ethnicity, hobbies, socioeconomic status) around it. For each, write one way it impacts your life (positive or challenging).

Example: Me → Indian → Love Diwali celebrations Me → Girl → Face stereotypes about being quiet

Your Identity Web: (Use the space below to draw and label your web. If needed, continue on the back of the page.)

Part 3: Cultural Pride and Challenges

Instructions: Reflect on the dual nature of cultural identity—pride and challenges. Answer the following questions with 2-3 sentences each.

- **Cultural Pride:** What is one thing about your culture that makes you proud? It could be a festival, food, history, or personal achievement tied to your heritage.
- **Cultural Challenges:** Have you or someone you know faced a challenge related to cultural identity, such as discrimination, stereotypes, or feeling disconnected from your roots? Describe it briefly and how it was handled or could be addressed.

Part 4: Sharing Stories

Instructions: Stories connect us to our culture and to each other. Think of a personal or family story related to your cultural background and answer the questions below. Then, prepare to share it briefly with a classmate or in a small group (if instructed by your teacher).

- **Your Story:** Write a short summary (3-5 sentences) of a cultural story from your life or family history. It could be about a holiday memory, a funny moment, or a lesson from an ancestor.
- **Why Share?** Why do you think sharing cultural stories is important, based on what you learned in the chapter? (1-2 sentences)

Part 5: Creative Activity – “Cultural Recipe Challenge”

Instructions: Imagine your cultural identity as a recipe (like a spicy biryani or a hearty burger). List 3-5 “ingredients” that make up who you are (e.g., “a dash of Indian humor from Dad” or “a spoonful of American independence”). Then, draw a small sketch of your “dish” in the space below or describe it if you’re not drawing.

- Ingredient 1: _____
- Ingredient 2: _____
- Ingredient 3: _____
- Ingredient 4: _____
- Ingredient 5: _____

Sketch or Description of Your Cultural Dish: (Use the space below or continue on the back if needed.)

Part 6: Critical Thinking Question

Instructions: Answer the following question in 3-5 sentences to reflect on the broader impact of cultural identity.

How can understanding your own cultural identity and listening to others’ stories help create a more inclusive environment at school or in your community?